These adaptations are seen in plants which live in terrestrial and desert habitats.

1. **Tendril Climbers**

Tendril is a twining climbing organ of some weak stemmed plants like peas and bitter gourd. Tendril coils round a support and helps the plant to climb.

Examples:

a. Sweet Peas (Lathyrus) - Leaflets are modified into tendrils.

b. Bitter Gourd - Axillary buds are modified into tendrils which help the plant to climb.



Lathyrus



Bamboo is one of the fast growing plants, during active growth phase.



2. **Twiners**

Some plants have weak stems. They cannot stand straight on their own. They must climb on any support to survive.

Example: Clitoria and Jasmine



Clitoria sps

3. **Thorns**

Leaves of some plants become wholly or partially modified into sharp pointed structures called 'thorns or spines' for defensive purpose.

Example:

a. Agave - The leaf apex and margins are modified into thorns.

b. Opuntia - The leaves are modified into spines.

c. Bougainvillea – The stem has sharp thorns.



Agave



Opuntia

Activity 6

Field Investigation

Name of the student:

Date :

Location :

Plant types to be observed:

1. A tendril climber
2. A twiner
3. A plant with thorn

Tabulate the modification that you have observed in these plants

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